

USI right from the onset has redefined the rules of the game and achieved a successful balance between quality, fashion and right pricing. Now even as the brand has expanded exponentially, its essential values have stood strong and are reflected across all operations across all their stores. Which is why today USI is recognised as an enterprise that offers more than just casual clothing - it offers an expression for all good things in life, with a heavy dose of ethical values; plus integrity, and customer satisfaction at all costs.

The ability to identify a niche in the market way back in 1990 and launching an avant-garde product (T-shirt) is a testimony of the visionary capabilities of the USI corporate team. Then after establishing a name in the T-shirt category early on, the company moved on to consolidate its existing customer with a more varied product range - stylish wear with a relaxed attitude. This too caught on tremendously. At USI the benchmarks are based on practicality, comfort and inherent sense of style. And 17 years on, these baseline pointers have helped stitch a super successful company where the future looks only better!

"It is not about money, nor is this a rat race, or a 'me too' philosophy, it is simply about creating a new world," shares Mr. Singh. Under his guidance USI has also consciously chosen to care for the environment, and about tomorrow and uses every platform possible for the cause. Even USI t-shirts!

THE CULT CALLED "METAL"

"Our vision is to create a Cult called METAL: a cult that youngsters identify with", say Singh "Metal intends to offer all what they need or inspire to have; not just the products (not to own, but to possess), also the ambience to hang out in, philosophy to follow religiously and the exclusivity to flaunt." Metal is a brand for the young, for the musicians and the music lovers, for the rockers and the rollers, for the rebels, for the individuals in a cult, for the self assured, for the strong, for the bold, for the different, for the travellers and the explorers, for the global, for the urban, for the aware, for the active. It is their attitude that is Metal's statement. Metal does not 'follow' any fashion statements; but it helps consumers create their own style - a trendy street style, casual and individual. No 1 word can describe it, there have to be many - gothic, street, punk, rock, niche, cult... There are at present two Metal stores located at prime locations: Saket and Vasant Vihar; showcasing only those brands which go with its image - youthful, casual, fashion forward and trendy. At Metal one can look out for many international brands (some not available anywhere else in India) - Tough, Von Dutch, New Rock, Chevignon, G.B. Eye Poster, Zippo, Jansport, Levis, Pyramid, Bico, Victorinox and more and shop with an attitude that screams 'Let us do what we want'.

FUTURE SPEAK

"India is one of the most dynamic economies of the world today, a happening market and is surely and steadily progressing into a superpower. Being in the midst of such

ADVANTAGE USI

- ✓ For GenNow USI offers international quality apparels, which are high on quality and fashion, but come at affordable prices.
- ✓ The core range of USI offers clothes that are essentially comfortable, trendy, well styled, and ready to wear in basic fits and in a wide range of colours - perfect for everyday wear.
- ✓ Beginning with its flagship store in the year 1995 at Greater Kailash, New Delhi; USI has followed a cautious expansion plan over the years and today has 22 exclusive stores spread across the country - expanding its reach to more and more USI converts.
- ✓ It has its presence in the major markets in 11 cities and towns across the country through 22 exclusive retail outlets, 130 multi-branded outlets and 12 shop-in-shops.
- ✓ Totally environment friendly USI uses 100% cotton fabric for 90% of its range and eco friendly dyes.
- ✓ They also have a special environment friendly range crafted in jute, and enhanced with colourful waste fabric.

an active industry is both challenging and exciting for a company like ours," opines Mr. Singh. "With the end of the quota regime, these are the changes I see in the apparel industry - the success factor for a brand will be a loyal customer. Our marketing team will thus keep on looking for newer avenues and channels to woo this customer. We will learn and apply from internationally successful examples and gear up to compete with more and more international players who enter the cash-rich Indian markets. I anticipate stiff-neck competition and a race for survival for both Indian and international brands and foresee that relationships will be redefined with many mergers and acquisitions amongst domestic brands. We of course believe in preparing ahead for everything," he adds. "The areas on which the brand USI intends to focus are: the tactile and aesthetic quality of the product, retail marketing and brand experience through the customer's eyes. Plus we intend to continue to utilise our most advantageous skill set - a clear focus. This helps us to differentiate, prioritise and position right. Which is why both USI and Metal have strong identities, both poles apart, with no overlap," he shares.